

PURCHASE BEHAVIOR

What thought and behavioral processes do millionaires go through before buying a car? We have done extensive research on the various types of vehicle buyers that exist among the ranks of millionaires. It seems that rich people differ significantly even among themselves. Studying these various findings reveals valuable information about the attitudes and behaviors necessary to accumulate wealth.

There are four distinct buyer types within the millionaire population. Underlying these four types are two fundamental factors. First is dealer loyalty. Some buyers have a proclivity to patronize the same dealer over and over again. In other words, when “dealer loyalists” want to acquire a motor vehicle, they are inclined to work with the dealer who sold them their last vehicle (and the vehicle before that). About 45.7 percent of the affluent are dealer loyalists (see [Table 4-3](#)).

All the other millionaires are shoppers. They account for 54.3 percent of the population. These people have no desire to patronize the same dealer. They are very aggressive, price-oriented buyers. Often they take months to make their price-related vehicle purchase.

The second factor underlying buyer types is vehicle choice—new or used. Among the affluent, 63.4 percent prefer and buy new cars. The balance, 36.6 percent, have a very strong proclivity to purchase used vehicles only. Putting these two factors together produces four types of millionaire car buyers (see [Table 4-3](#)):

- ◆ Type 1: New Vehicle-Prone Dealer Loyalists (28.6 percent)
- ◆ Type 2: New Vehicle-Prone Dealer Shoppers (34.8 percent)
- ◆ Type 3: Used Vehicle-Prone Dealer Loyalists (17.1 percent)
- ◆ Type 4: Used Vehicle–Prone Shoppers (19.5 percent).

NEW VEHICLE-PRONE DEALER LOYALISTS (28.6 PERCENT)